Abdullah Al Zahid

Toronto, ON | (780) 982-3680 | azahid1@ualberta.ca | linkedin.com/in/abdullah-al-zahid

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Talent Acquisition
Marketing Customer Analytics Office
Metrolinx, 10 Bay Street, Toronto, ON

Re: Data Scientist II, 6-Month Term (Job ID 117614)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Data Scientist II position with the Marketing Customer Analytics Office. I worked at Metrolinx in 2023 as a Transportation Planner in Service Design, and I am now an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto. The posting's central question, what a change in GO and UP service levels does to ridership and revenue, sits next to the one I worked on: what a change does to the service itself.

At Metrolinx I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward, and presented that evidence to schedulers, operations staff and engineers. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

At the City I analyze travel and network data, including several years of the Transportation Tomorrow Survey, and I built the Transportation Data Dashboard, which combined several years of survey data into one validated source the division reports from. I work in Python and SQL, and I write up results for readers without a modelling background. My master's research used agent-based (MATSim) and macroscopic models.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not trained machine learning models or built ridership and revenue forecasts, and I have not used PySpark, Power BI, Microsoft Azure or Databricks, or run A/B tests. I am applying because the modelling and data work behind the role is familiar, and I know the GO service it would be forecasting.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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